# M.E. Sparks

www.mesparks.com
b. Kenora, ON, Canada

## Education

2016 Master of Fine Arts, Emily Carr University of Art + Design, Vancouver, BC
2013 Bachelor of Fine Arts, NSCAD University, Halifax, NS

## Solo & Two-Person Exhibitions

2025 *Perennial,* aceartinc. Winnipeg, MB (solo)
2022 *and a Rag in the Other*, Alternator Centre for Contemporary Art, Kelowna, BC (solo)
2021 *A Fine Line*, Trapp Projects, Vancouver, BC (two-person)
2019 *Hiatus,* The Ou Gallery, Duncan, BC (solo)
*Pleated Fingers Parted,* The Fifty Fifty Arts Collective, Victoria, BC (solo)
2018 *near channels,* Support, London, ON (two-person, curated by Graham Macaulay)
*Inside Out*, SiteFactory, Vancouver, BC (two-person, curated by Leah Weinstein)
*Mother Tongue*, Dynamo Arts Association, Vancouver, BC (two-person)
2016 *Still Here*, Point Gallery, Salt Spring Island, BC (solo)
2015 *LINEUP*, Helen For Now Gallery, ECUAD, Vancouver, BC (two-person)
*Drift*, First Floor Gallery, Barrie, ON (two-person)
2014 *Image Search,* Corridor Gallery, VANS, Halifax, NS (solo)
*From There to Here*, Eventide Art Gallery, New Glasgow, NS (solo)
*Still Life*, Anna Leonowens Gallery, NSCAD, Halifax, NS (solo)

## Selected Group Exhibitions

2026 *What Colour is the Sacred?,* Galerie Buhler Gallery, Winnipeg, MB (curated by hannah_g)
2025 *Soft Power,* Galerie Shibumi, New York, NY (curated by Folana Miller)
*Touchy*, 226 Main St. Gallery, Winnipeg, MB
*Turned and Turning Still,* The Painting Center, New York, NY
*Undercurrents,* NARS Foundation, New York, NY (curated by Joyous Pierce)
*Piece and Parse*, 226 Main St. Gallery, Winnipeg, MB (curated by Lindsay Inglis)
2022 *We can only hint at this with words.*, Gordon Smith Gallery of Canadian Art, North Vancouver, BC (curated by Kate Henderson)
2019 *13suite15,* 2244 East Hastings, Vancouver, BC
*Road Trip*, Monica Reyes Gallery, Vancouver, BC
*some body, anybody,* SOMA Gallery, Vancouver, BC
2017 *A Terrible Signal,* Access Gallery, Vancouver, BC (curated by Kimberly Phillips)
*RBC Painting Competition (19th Annual)*, National Gallery of Canada, Ottawa, ON
*Dear Home*, GlogauAIR, Berlin, Germany
*Shape Form Colour Line*, Elissa Cristall Gallery, Vancouver, BC
*Bad Drawings,* Institut für Alles Mögliche, Berlin, Germany
2016 *A Beast Salient,* Franc Gallery, Vancouver, BC (curated by Brynn McNab)
*RBC Painting Competition (18th Annual),* The Power Plant, Toronto, ON

*Endless Summer,* Elissa Cristall Gallery, Vancouver, BC
*Fresh Paint / New Construction,* Art Mûr, Montreal, QC
*see level,* Charles H. Scott Gallery, Vancouver, BC
*Still Here,* MFA Thesis Exhibition, Concourse Gallery, ECUAD, Vancouver, BC

2015 *Salt Spring National Art Prize Exhibition*, Mahon Hall, Salt Spring Island, BC
*Flight Lines,* Concourse Gallery, ECUAD, Vancouver, BC

2014 *By and By,* Port Loggia Gallery, Halifax, NS
*Redux,* The Craig Gallery, Dartmouth, NS (curated by Teto Elsiddique)

## Awards & Grants

2025 Canada Council for the Arts: Concept to Realization Grant
2025 Salt Spring National Art Prize, Finalist, Mahon Hall, Salt Spring Island, BC
2025 Manitoba Arts Council: Professional Development Travel Grant
2025 Winnipeg Arts Council: Professional Development Travel Grant
2025 Manitoba Arts Council: Individual Project Grant
2024 Canada Council for the Arts: Arts Abroad Residencies Grant
2024 Manitoba Arts Council: Learn/Travel
2023 Winnipeg Arts Council: Individual Project Grant
2022 Winnipeg Arts Council: Professional Development Travel Grant
2021 BC Arts Council: Project Assistance Grant
2020 Canada Council for the Arts: Research and Creation Grant
2019 Salt Spring National Art Prize: Finalist, Mahon Hall, Salt Spring Island, BC
2018 Canada Council for the Arts: Research and Creation Grant
2018 BC Arts Council: Project Assistance Grant
2017 19th Annual RBC Painting Competition: Finalist
2016 18th Annual RBC Painting Competition: Finalist
2016 Nancy Petry Foundation Award: Royal Canadian Academy of Arts & Joseph Plaskett Foundation
2016 Valedictorian, Master of Fine Arts, Emily Carr University of Art + Design
2015 Salt Spring National Art Prize: Juror's Choice Award
2015 BC Arts Council Scholarship
2014 Gordon and Marion Smith Painting Scholarship, Emily Carr University
2013 Nova Scotia Talent Trust Scholarship
2013 Arts Nova Scotia Creation Grant
2012 Robert Pope Foundation Painting Scholarship, NSCAD University
2009 Canada Millennium Foundation Scholarship

## Residencies

2025 NARS Foundation International Artist Residency, Brooklyn, NY
2024 Vermont Studio Center Residency Program, Johnson, VT
2017 GlogauAIR gGmbH Artist Residency, Berlin, Germany
2017 Arteles Creative Center Residency: *Silence Awareness Existence*, Haukijärvi, Finland
2017 Institut für Alles Mögliche, Artist Residency, Berlin, Germany
2013-14 NSCAD Studio Residency, New Glasgow, NS

## Public Presentations & Panels

2025 Panelist, *Soft Power: Reimagining Form and Feeling*, Galerie Shibumi, New York, NY
2025 Artist Talk, *Perennial,* in conversation with Suzie Smith, Ace Art Inc., Winnipeg, MB
2025 Artist Talk, "STDO1510: Art Now", instructor Katherine Boyer, School of Art, University of Manitoba, Winnipeg, MB
2024 Panelist, *Wrestling with Static*, Ace Art Inc., Winnipeg, MB
2022 Oseredok Ukrainian Cultural and Educational Centre, "Hard Edge, Soft Body: On the Paintings of Christina Senkiw", Research Lecture, Winnipeg, MB
2022 Panelist, *We can only hint at this with words*, Gordon Smith Gallery of Canadian Art
2022 Panelist, Conversations in Contemporary Art (CiCA), Concordia University, online 2020
2020 Visiting Speaker for the MFA program, Emily Carr University, Vancouver, BC
2020 Artist Talk with Matthis Grunsky, NSCAD University, Media Toolbox Course, Halifax, NS
2019 Visiting Speaker for the MFA program, Simon Fraser University, Vancouver, BC
2018 Panelist, *some body, anybody*, SOMA Gallery, Vancouver, BC
2018 Visiting Speaker for the BFA program, University of the Fraser Valley, Abbotsford, BC
2018 Alumni Presentations, Emily Carr University, Vancouver BC
2018 Overly Dedicated: Artist Podcast, Interview, hosted and produced by Claire Scherzinger
2018 Artist Talk, AFK 25th Paradise Valley Summer Visual Arts Intensive, Squamish, BC
2017 Panelist, *A Crimp in the Fabric: Situating Painting Today*, Simon Fraser University, Vancouver, BC
2017 Alumni Presentations, Emily Carr University, Vancouver BC
2016 Panelist, *see level*, Charles H. Scott Gallery, Vancouver BC
2013 Artist Talk, *From There To Here*, NSCAD Artists in Residence, New Glasgow, NS
2013 Artist Talk, *Still Life*, Anna Leonowens Gallery, Halifax, NS

## Workshops & Mentorships

2026-27 MAWA (Mentoring Artists for Women's Art) Foundation Mentorship Program, Mentor (1-year), Winnipeg,MB
2026 University of Applied Arts Vienna, "Edges of Becoming", Collaborative Drawing Workshop, facilitated with Jo O'Brien, Vienna, Austria, May 28
2023 MAWA Focused Mentorship, "Painting & The Studio", Mentor (2-months), Winnipeg, MB
2018 25th Paradise Valley Summer Visual Arts Intensive, Guest Artist, 1-week Expanded Painting Workshop, Squamish, BC
2018 Gordon Smith Gallery, Artists for Kids, Guest Artist, Collage Workshop, Vancouver, BC

## Reviews, Press & Exhibition Texts

2026 Tom Kohut, Review in Border Crossings, issue #170, March 2026
2025 Annie Kierans, "Sundialing", written response to solo exhibition *Perennial,* ace**art**inc.
2025 Madeline Bogoch, "Handle with Care", exhibition essay, 226 Main St. Gallery
2025 Zoë Mills, "Thinking Outside the Frame", The Uniter, Volume 80 Number 10, Winnipeg, MB
2025 *Art Wold Innovators,* radio interview hosted by Susan Cohn
2025 *Eat your arts and vegetables,* radio interview hosted by Derek Brueckner

2025 Lindsay Inglis, “Liminal Gathering”, exhibition essay, 226 Main St. Gallery
2024 Lindsay Inglis, Interview for Public Parking, online journal, April 2024
2024 *Canthius: Feminism and Literary Arts*, Artist Feature and Interview, Issue 13, Ottawa, ON
2022 Jayne Wilkinson, *“*Surface Tensions: On Works by Russna Kaur and M.E. Sparks”*,* essay included in exhibition publication for *We can only hint at this with words.,* Gordon Smith Gallery of Canadian Arts
2022 Katherine Pickering, *and a Rag in the Other* // An Interview with M.E. Sparks, Alternator Centre for Contemporary Art
2018 Kevin Griffin, “ART SEEN: Art installation in a school bus…”, Vancouver Sun, June 2018
2018 Joe O’Brien, “Inside Out”, exhibition text, SiteFactory, July 2018
2018 Angela Glanzmann, “Mother Tongue”, exhibition text, Dynamo Arts Association
2017 Kimberly Phillips, “A Terrible Signal”, Curatorial Essay, Access Gallery
2017 RBC Painting Competition Catalogue, Canadian Art, September 201
2017 Lucien Durey,“Vancouver Report:From Black and White to Coloured Lights”, Canadian Art
2016 RBC Painting Competition Catalogue, Canadian Art, September 2016
2015 SSNAP Finalist Exhibition Catalogue, Art Barn International, October 2015

## Writing & Contributions to Publications

2024 “Blanket Charades (Thoughts on Taking Shape)”, exhibition text for Wrestling with Static, ace art inc., Winnipeg, MB
2022 *in_your_painting*, zine publication, Alternator Centre for Contemporary Art, Kelowna, BC
2022 *We can only hint at this with words*., exhibition publication, Gordon Smith Gallery of Canadian Art, North Vancouver, BC
2019 *Paperwait*, Volume 21, Ace Art Inc., Winnipeg, MB
2018 *Materials*, Volume 4, July 2018, Support, London, ON
2018 “Surfacing: Looking at the Paintings of Ben Reeves”, exhibition catalogue essay for *Floating Among Phantoms*, Art Gallery at Evergreen, Coquitlam, BC

## Collections

Galerie Buhler Gallery Permanent Collection 2026
RBC Corporate Collection 2017
International Private Collections

## Artwork Donations & Fairs

2026 Centre for Culture & Artistic Practices, “Off/Cuts” Fundraiser, Winnipeg, MB, May 28
2025 Platform Centre for Photographic + Digital Arts, “11x14”, Fundraiser, Winnipeg, MB, December 6
2023 Riverview Montessori, “Grownups Get Out”, Auction, Winnipeg, MB, April 26
2023 Gordon Smith Gallery of Canadian Art, Brilliance Gala, Auction, North Vancouver, BC, June 15
2021 Combine: An Art Fair, Griffin Art Projects, Vancouver, BC, December 5
2021 The Polygon Gallery Auction, North Vancouver, BC, June 2
2020 Trapp Projects, Trapped in 2020: Works on Paper, Vancouver, BC

2019 Access Gallery, Access Auction Fundraiser, Vancouver, BC
2018 Canadian Art Social, Toronto, ON
2017 #3 Gallery Auction, R Gallery, Vancouver, BC
2017 Contemporary Art Gallery Gala & Auction, CAG, Vancouver, BC
2017 C Magazine, Contemporary Art Auction, Division Gallery, Toronto, ON
2016 Access Gallery, Access Auction Fundraiser XXV, Vancouver, BC
2015 Off the Hook: Art Auction, The MacLaren Art Centre, Barrie, ON